

Oregon Road '83 Art Team

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Introduction

Oregon Road '83 aims to show a post-nuclear-apocalyptic United States through a retro lens. In the game, the United States has been destroyed by a nuclear war with the Soviet Union in 1983. The goal of the main character is to reach Oregon, similar to the original *Oregon Trail*, which inspired the game. Along the way, the player will face obstacles related to nuclear fallout and survival. The game combines survival elements with a nostalgic pixel-art style to create an immersive and challenging experience for players.

Goal of Study

The goal of the art team this summer was to develop the introductory sequence of *Oregon Road '83*.

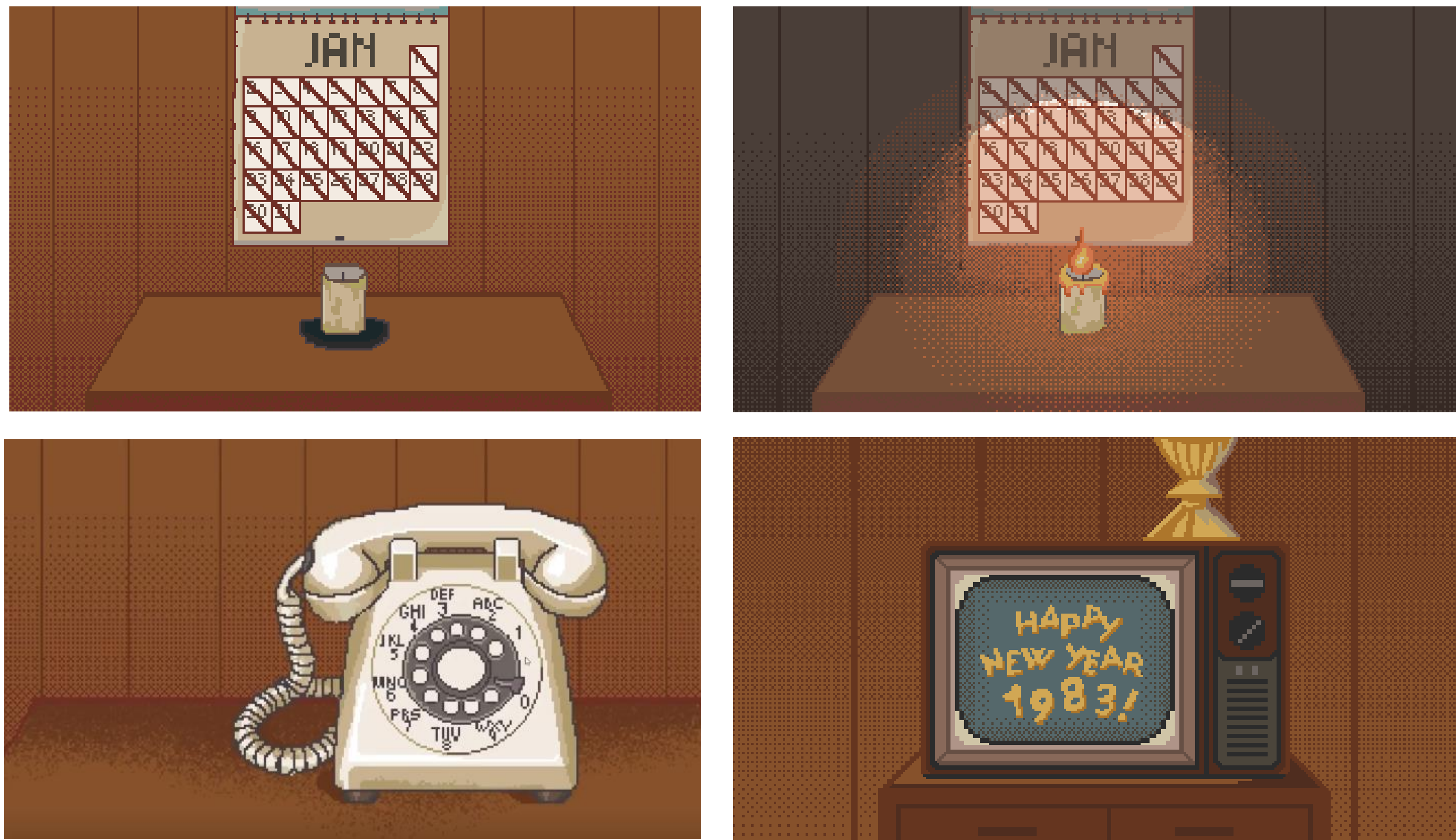
Methods

- Organized tasks in Trello and gathered references from previous years' work
- Sketched the intro sequence and wrote its dialogue in Procreate
- Created the final pixel art in Aseprite: rotary phone, calendar, television, and candle/calendar scenes before and after the war
- Implemented the finished art into the game using its dev tools and JavaScript

References

- Oregon Trail*: the classic game that inspired OR83's structure and journey premise
- Tools: Aseprite (pixel art), Procreate (initial sketches), Phaser 3 (game engine), Trello (task tracking)

Results



Main Takeaways

- Built a working prototype of the intro sequence with fully original pixel art
- Established an art-to-engine pipeline: assets drawn in Aseprite, encoded to base64, and loaded into the Phaser game through the Even Editor
- Produced the core intro assets: bunker room, calendar montage, rotary phone, CRT television, framed family photos, and candle scenes before and after the war

Future Prospects

- Finish implementing all intro scenes with dialogue and the two branching choice moments during the phone call
- Build transparent number sprites for a countdown “number-drop” effect
- Hand off cleanly into the bunker gameplay that follows the intro

Acknowledgements

- Professor Alex Wellerstein: research professor, who created the original room background art and set up the tooling/pipeline the team worked in
- Previous years' art students (their reference folders)